

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

Red 2/5/01 wpe

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): EURASIAN COLLARED-DOVE

(Scientific Name) *Streptopelia decaocto*

Date(s) of occurrence: 1 April 2000

Number of birds seen: One

Sex: Unknown

Plumage: Adult

Exact Location: "Ovid Woods" in the Town of Ovid

County: Sedgwick County

Nearest town: Ovid

Elevation: 3540 msl

Length of observation: Roughly 5 minutes

Time(s) of observation: Approximately 5:30 MST

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Chris Wood, Tony Leukering

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s):

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Mostly clear skies in late afternoon with sun to back.

Optical equipment used: 8x40 Binoculars

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Roughly 40 feet

Was bird(s) photographed? Yes (video)

If so, have you submitted photos? No

Who took the photographs? Chris Wood

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Riparian woodland/thicket along small stream. Bird perched atop tree adjacent to road. Grain elevators located in the nearby vicinity.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification):

Observed flying to tree where it perched for a few minutes.

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

As we were departing "Ovid Woods" after just observing a Carolina Wren, I noticed a chunky dove fly by and perch atop a tree adjacent to the road. All three of us immediately identified the bird as a Eurasian Collared-Dove. The bird was noticeably chunkier and shorter tailed than a Mourning Dove. The tail was white-tipped on the outer rectrices (as in Mourning Dove) but was shorter and "fan-shaped" in contrast to the long-tapered tail of a Mourning Dove. Overall coloration was a warm, light buffy-gray, quite unlike the earth-brown pattern of Mourning Doves. A thin, dark band formed a half-collar around the neck. The eyes appeared reddish. From beneath, the tail was mostly white with blackish outer edges to the basal rectrices. When in flight and while perched, the primaries appeared charcoal-colored and contrasted with the remainder of the buffy-gray wings.

Describe bird's call or song: None noted

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: The presence of a black half-collar, reddish eyes, buffy-gray coloration, shorter, and short fan-shaped tail eliminates Mourning Dove. Domestic Ringed Turtle Dove was eliminated based upon its smaller overall size, lighter gray/cream/buffy coloration, lighter wingtips (less contrasting with remainder of wing), and lack of black outer edges to the basal half of the undersides of the rectrices. White-winged Dove would be less predictable at this locale and would have a black cheek mark, a bright white patch in the wings (which are extremely evident while perched), and would have even darker wings contrasting with the body.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? Have observed numerous other Eurasian Collared-Doves in Florida, Louisiana, Texas, and in Colorado (Rocky Ford, Springfield).

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None

This report is from notes made during or after XX observation or later from memory

Date of written report: 11/29/00

Reporting observer: Larry Semo

Signature:

Larry Semo